



FAITH INTERNATIONAL UNIVERSITY

TH7323: Worldviews and Christianity (MACE) Online Course Syllabus

Title	Worldviews and Christianity	Number	TH 7323
Credit Hours	4	Type	Online/Hybrid
Instructor	Dennis Jowers, Ph.D.	Contact	djowers@faithiu.edu (Use Mail icon in Canvas)
Campus	3504 N. Pearl Street Tacoma, WA 98407	Office	253-752-2020

Course Description

An introduction to the nature and function of a worldview with an argument for the value of developing and living an explicitly Christian worldview. Throughout the course, the student will gain understanding of various worldviews (pre-modern, non-modern, modern, and post-modern). May be applied to the DMin program.

Canvas Interaction Requirements

Student interaction is an integral part of the Online/Distance Education learning experience. Successful completion of this course requires that students log into the course via the Canvas Learning Management System. Regular and substantive interaction with both the instructor and classmates is required throughout the quarter. Academic exercises will be listed on the course syllabus and include, but are not limited to, reading textbooks and journal articles, watching videos, listening to audio, PowerPoint/PDF slides, discussion postings, quizzes, examinations, reflection and/or research papers, written assignments, field work, and practicums. Regular and timely participation in is expected in all courses at Faith.

Faculty Interaction Requirements:

The professor will provide student(s) with specific details relevant to assigned coursework. He/she will submit student feedback via Canvas within a reasonable timeframe. Each professor is committed to engaging with student(s) in a manner that is courteous, professional and consistent with Christian character (Gal. 5:22–23, 6:1–2; John 13:34–35, and so on).

Substantive Interaction Statement:

A student may be withdrawn for cause by either the instructor or the Registrar. A student who does not participate regularly and substantively, and/or whose number of absences prevents him/her from meeting the objectives of the course, will be withdrawn for failure to maintain Satisfactory Academic Progress (as defined in the Academic Catalog). Students who do not check-in to a course and interact substantively within the first two weeks of a quarter are subject to Administrative Withdrawal (WX) as defined in the Academic Catalog.

Course Texts / Media

Required:

Sire, James. *The Universe Next Door: A Basic Worldview Catalog*. 5th ed. Downers Grove, Ill.: IVP Academic, 2009. (List Price: \$25.00). ISBN [9780830838509](#)

Naugle, David. *Worldview: The History of a Concept*. Grand Rapids, Mich.: Eerdmans, 2002. (List Price: \$34.00). ISBN [9780802847614](#)

Johnson, Philip. *The Wedge of Truth: Splitting the Foundations of Naturalism*. Downers Grove, Ill.: IVP, 2000. (List Price: \$14.00). ISBN [9780830823956](#)

Groothuis, Douglas. *Truth Decay: Defending Christianity Against the Challenges of Postmodernism*. Downers Grove, Ill.: IVP, 2000. (List Price: \$16.00). ISBN [9780830822287](#)

Course Goals / Student Learning Objectives/Outcomes

Upon successful completion of this course, the student should be able to:

1. describe a basically Christian worldview over against contemporary alternatives;
2. identify and discuss intelligently the non-Christian worldviews that command widespread allegiance in the industrialized West of today;
3. relate claims to knowledge, Christian and otherwise, to the worldview commitments they presuppose;
4. show, in some measure at least, how Christianity addresses basic questions about human existence more credibly and adequately than its principal competitors; and
5. articulate ways in which knowledge of worldviews can be applied in ministry.

Assessment Tools Matrix

Assessment Tools	Student Learning Objective 1	Student Learning Objective 2	Student Learning Objective 3	Student Learning Objective 4	Student Learning Objective 5	
Canvas Video Discussion Board					(x)	
Student Introduction					(x)	
Discussion Boards					(x)	
Comments on Other Students' Discussion Board Posts					(x)	
Essay	(x)	(x)	(x)	(x)		

Course Requirements

All coursework will be submitted through Canvas in each assignment's drop box or through the Canvas "Inbox." *Do not send your assignments anywhere else, as there is no guarantee that they will be received by the proper instructor at the proper time.*

A. Student Introduction 5% Module 1

Introduce yourself to your classmates by explaining the degree which you are pursuing your current or future ministry, and the knowledge which you would like to gain from this course.

B. Canvas Video Discussion Board 5% Module 1

Watch the "Introduction to Canvas Video" and post one comment about online learning, the subject of this course, and ministries conducted by distance. For example, Paul wrote letters to churches far removed from his prison cell so as to help Christians develop spiritually. Your post should contain 50-100 words. The online learning requirements presented in this video are vital to help ensure student success in the Institution's online education programs.

C. Discussion Posts 25% Modules 2, 4, 6, and 8

Students will be required to participate in discussions as assigned by the instructor. These interactions will require a mid-week response to allow time for both instructor-to-student and student-to-student(s) engagement. Students' initial discussion posts are minimally 150–200 words.

D. Comments on Other Students' Discussion Board Posts 5% Modules 3 and 5

Students will comment on the discussion board posts of other students in 100-150 words.

E. Essay and Book Report 60% Module 10

Students will complete one essay of at least **4,000 words** which includes references to at least **10 relevant peer-reviewed sources** obtained through databases such as EBSCO and ATLA. Information on these databases and other online resources is provided in Module (Week) One. Sample topics:

- Explain why Christianity is superior to any of the non-Christian worldviews studied (for example, Naturalism or Post-Modernism).
- How does Christianity differ from "moralistic therapeutic deism?"
- Can a naturalist or existentialist live according to the principles which he or she professes to believe?

Include as an appendix to your essay a **book report of 250-500 words** (these words are in addition to those specified for the essay). This book report should summarize the assigned course readings and discuss the ways in which the course textbooks and any other assigned readings influenced your topic selection as well as your understanding of the chosen topic. Incorporate specific and meaningful references to all assigned texts throughout your book report.

Grading Scale and Weights

Score	Grade	Quality Points	Definition	Assignment	Weights
98 – 100	A+	4.0	Superior	Student Introduction	5%
94 – 97	A	4.0		Canvas Video	5%
90 – 93	A–	3.7	Excellent	Discussion Posts	25%
87 – 89	B+	3.3		Comments	5%
84 – 86	B	3.0	Good	Essay & Book Report	60%
				Total	100%
80 – 83	B–	2.7			
77 – 79	C+	2.3			
74 – 76	C	2.0	Average		
70 – 73	C–	1.7			
67 – 69	D+	1.3			
64 – 66	D	1.0	Below		
60 – 63	D–	0.7			
Below 60	F	0.0	Failing		

Grading Policies

Student work is evaluated according to the above grading criteria.

End of Course Evaluation

Completing the End of Course Evaluation is a **required** element in each course. Students need to complete the evaluation in Populi prior to their grades being visible at the end of each quarter. Once the End of Course Evaluation has been completed and your professor has finalized the course, your grade will be visible within Populi. The evaluation is available during week 8.

Faith Policy/Academic Integrity

Academic Code of Honor:

Christian character and academic honesty are foundational to the mission of Faith International University and Seminary. Students are expected to demonstrate integrity and honor utilizing any mode of instruction and recognize the importance of being accountable for personal academic behavior.

Students have the responsibility to be knowledgeable of and abide by the Academic Code of Honor and encourage honesty and integrity among fellow students. Students are required to conduct themselves in a Christ-like manner both behaviorally and ethically during the entire process of their education or be subject to disciplinary action. A non-exhaustive list of behavioral and ethical standards is offered below.

Behavioral Standards:

1. Students will attend all class sessions, arrive on time, and remain until dismissed.
2. Students will be respectful, courteous, and civil when communicating verbally or in writing with their instructor, fellow students, other faculty members, or administrative staff.
3. Students will be prepared for class and maintain an appropriate academic climate by refraining from all actions that disrupt the learning environment.
4. Students will do assigned coursework in a consistent, timely manner throughout the quarter.
5. Students will pay tuition, fees, and other charges according to financial policies.

Ethical Standards:

1. Students will submit their own course work.
2. Students will not cheat by utilizing unauthorized communication of information or give illicit aid to other students on examinations, papers, or projects.
3. Students will not plagiarize by representing someone else's words or ideas from books, articles, electronic sources (Internet), Bible software, etc., as one's own without proper citation.
4. Students will not falsify, distort, or invent any information, data, or citation.
5. Students will not submit the same work to more than one class or submit any work that has been used to fulfill the requirements of another course previously taken at another school.

Faith Seminary Mission Statement

Faith International University & Seminary exists to glorify God by equipping Christian leaders with a biblical, theological, and practical education empowering them to apply and proclaim the inerrant Word of God for worldwide Christian service.

Accessibility and Consent Agreement**Disability and Support Services (DSS):**

If you are a student with a disability and want to discuss or request services, please contact the Disability Support Services (DSS) office. Accommodations for qualified students are handled through this office. The Coordinator for DSS can be reached at (253) 752-2020 x120.

Consent Agreement

An on-line/distance learning course requires frequent interaction with your instructor. It is, therefore, essential that you agree to the conditions set forth in the course syllabus. After you have read the course syllabus, let us know (do not wait) if you do not agree with the course conditions and requirements. If we do not hear from you within three (3) days from the start of the course, we will assume you agree with the conditions set forth in the syllabus.

Academic Work Quality

Faith International University & Seminary strives to bring its students quality instruction in order to challenge students to their highest levels of performance. Students are exposed to high-quality textbooks, journals, and other scholarly media as part of required coursework. Likewise, students are expected to focus on high-quality academic sources in their own coursework and research when writing and submitting papers, theses, or presenting similar assignments and projects. A hierarchy of scholarly research books and journals exists from which acceptable research reading and citation sources may be obtained.

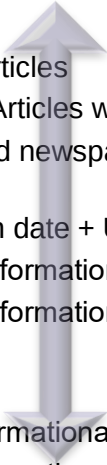
Excellent book and journal resources, as well as reference books are found in the FECS and other libraries. Additionally, many important and classic works may be found online and in Bible and research software packages. The Internet is mixed in the quality of research resources to be found, however good sources are available if students look carefully.

Impeccable citation of sources is expected and students should limit direct quotations to a maximum of thirty percent of the paper or presentation.

The following is a general “Hierarchy of Sources” for research and study:

Hierarchy of Sources

Most Acceptable/Academic Internet Sources

- Primary source documents
 - Established classic volumes
 - Peer-reviewed books and journal articles
 - Journal Articles with DOI / Journal Articles with URL
 - Dual print and electronic established newspaper/news magazine + publication date + URL
 - Electronic news media + publication date + URL
 - Established/formal organization’s informational media + publication date + URL
 - Established/formal organization’s informational media + no pub. date + access date + URL
 - Wikipedia and similar sources
 - Popular/informal organization’s informational media + publication date + URL
 - Popular/informal organization’s informational media + no publication date + access date + URL
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Least Acceptable Sources

Sequence of Instruction		Students are expected to participate in discussions as scheduled. Replies and interactions with other students are also required. (See Class Requirements.)	
Week	Due Date	Assignments	Reading Assignment
1	Saturday 11:59 p.m. (PST), Week One	Student Introduction Canvas Video Discussion Video Lecture	Read Chapter 1 (“A World of Difference”) and Chapter 2 (“Christian Theism”) in <i>Universe Next Door</i> , and chapters 1 and 2 in Naugle, <i>Worldview</i> .
2	Saturday 11:59 p.m. (PST), Week Two	Discussion Board #1 Video Lecture	Read Chapter 3 (“Deism”) in <i>Universe Next Door</i> , and chapters 3–5 in Naugle, <i>Worldview</i> .
3	Saturday 11:59 p.m. (PST), Week Three	Comments on Another Student's Discussion Board Post from Week Two Video Lecture	Read Chapter 4 (“Naturalism”) in <i>Universe Next Door</i> , and chapters 6–8 in Naugle, <i>Worldview</i> .
4	Saturday 11:59 p.m. (PST), Week Four	Discussion Board #2 Video Lecture	Read Chapter 5 (“Nihilism”) in <i>Universe Next Door</i> , and chapters 9–11 and Appendix A in Naugle, <i>Worldview</i> .
5	Saturday 11:59 p.m. (PST), Week Five	Comments on Another Student's Discussion Board Post from Week Four Video Lecture	Read Chapter 6 (“Existentialism”) in <i>Universe Next Door</i> , and chapters 1–4 in Johnson, <i>Wedge of Truth</i> .
6	Saturday 11:59 p.m. (PST), Week Six	Discussion Board #3 Video Lecture	Read Chapter 7 (“Eastern Pantheistic Monism”) in <i>Universe Next Door</i> , and chapters 5–8 in Johnson, <i>Wedge of Truth</i> .
7	Saturday 11:59 p.m. (PST), Week Seven	Video Lecture	Read Chapter 8 (“The New Age”) in <i>Universe Next Door</i> , and “Introduction” as well as chapters 1 and 2 in Groothuis, <i>Truth Decay</i> .
8	Saturday 11:59 p.m. (PST), Week Eight	Discussion Board #4 Video Lecture	Read Chapter 9 (“Postmodernism”) in <i>Universe Next Door</i> , and chapters 3–5 in Groothuis, <i>Truth Decay</i> .
9	Saturday 11:59 p.m. (PST), Week Nine	Video Lecture	Read Chapter 10 (“Islamic Theism”) in <i>Universe Next Door</i> , and chapters 6–8 in Groothuis, <i>Truth Decay</i> .
10	Saturday 11:59 p.m. (PST), Week Ten	Video Lecture Essay & Book Report End of Course Survey	Read Chapter 11 (“The Examined Life”) in <i>Universe Next Door</i> , as well as chapters 9–11 and “Appendix: Television: Agent of Truth Decay” in Groothuis, <i>Truth Decay</i> .